And that pressure sometimes makes you do silly things.

The final was played at the Wanderers in front of a capacity crowd. It was loud, and it was just the kind of scenario I love. We batted first; Gilly and I were opening. Once we'd walked out onto the field and got to the middle, we realised that they were going to open the bowling with Indian spinner Anil Kumble. I see him warming up and setting the field, so I walk up to Gilly and say, 'Listen, boet, just give yourself a few balls so that you can have a look.' I probably didn't say 'boet'; probably 'mate'. I dunno.

But Gilly hits the first ball straight to a fielder, blocks the second, and then, with the third bladdy ball, runs down the pitch, misses the ball and gets bowled. Unbelievable. A prime example of how the Aussie confidence can sometimes work to their players' detriment. Sometimes they go out once too often to try to dominate, irrespective of the situation.

So now our main guy is out, and it's the final … We've got a fair number of younger, inexperienced guys in the team, and it's a funny sort of wicket – a little bit slow. You just couldn't get the ball away. I had no choice but to drop anchor and, after 10 overs, I'm on, like, 20. Ridiculous for a 20-over game! Still, somebody had to try to bat through the innings.

Andrew Symonds joined me and smashed a few quick ones before being really unlucky to get out, while trying to pull Kumble. The ball came off Symonds's thigh pad and rolled right onto his stumps. Meanwhile I was telling myself, 'Just hang in there; hang in there, and you'll be able to get the run rate up in the last few overs.' Which, luckily, I was able to do. Unfortunately, I didn't get to face a ball in the last over, or we might have scored in the range of 155.

I walked off knowing we had a total of only 143, but that it was a final, after all. And anything can happen when the pressure is on.

Rahul Dravid's dismissal in that game was a perfect example. I mean, here was a guy who had played in numerous high-pressure games. He was usually as unflappable as one got, but in this final, at a crucial time for the Royal Challengers, he played a ridiculous shot to get out. He tried to play a little paddle against Harmeet Singh and got bowled. In a normal game he would never have tried that shot at that time. There was panic written all over it.

But, as I said, funny things happen in a final.

There were a couple of good stumpings by Gilly, and Mark Boucher hit the ball straight to me at point … but by then the game was over anyway.